# Teaching Statement

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I came to economics relatively late, after working as a soil scientist on agricultural development issues. This means that I very clearly remember the things which were difficult for me to learn when I was learning economics and I have adapted my teaching style accordingly. These things are usually less the difficult mathematical concepts themselves than understanding the purpose of different economic models and econometric estimators; if and how one can apply these models to answer questions of interest; what each approach takes for granted; and what its limitations may be.

## 1. Experience

Since starting at Mohammed VI Polytechnic University, I have worked as a Teaching Assistant to Professor Amine Ben Amar on three courses: Essentials of Financial Markets (January to February 2025, first-year Master's, Africa Business School), Microeconomics (September to November 2026, first-year undergraduate) and Financial Econometrics (September to November 2026, second-year Master's).

Together with Professor Ben Amar, I co-developed and taught Lecture 5 of Financial Econometrics. The lecture was developed to be delivered in two three-hour sessions, with one session teaching vector auto-regressions (VARs), structural VARs and Granger causality tests, and the other teaching local projections, time-varying local projections with stochastic volatility and wavelet analysis. Given that these concepts are taught for the first time in this lecture, each block of the lecture opens with a slide of definitions for the concepts that it discusses. The lecture contains a large number of tables and figures, all of which are generated by R scripts which run on data contained within the student pack for the lecture. The student pack, which I developed for the lecture, contains the 9 scripts used in the lecture, the data on which the scripts are run, and a guide detailing the steps that the student must take to produce the results. I tested the student pack on a clean installation of R and RStudio, where it runs without the student needing access to the internet, following installation of the packages. I also wrote a slide-by-slide description of the lecture, which explains the thinking behind each of the results shown in the slides. For the lecture, I developed an exercise for students, which asked them to use time-frequency analysis techniques to answer a number of questions. I reviewed the exercises submitted by 21 students.

The two courses that I am currently teaching are somewhat different: one a large introductory course, the other a smaller course aimed at master's students towards the end of their degree.

However, in both cases it is important to make sure the students understand why they are learning a particular concept before delving into the mathematics behind the concept. First-year students will only put effort into a budget constraint or a supply curve once they see what it is good for, while master's students can usually run the code and need more help deciding whether an estimate really says what it seems to say.

Prior to starting my doctorate, I coordinated agricultural development programmes in Nigeria and wrote policy briefs on climate-smart agriculture for government counterparts. This entailed explaining concepts to a range of different audiences with different backgrounds. It taught me to begin with what listeners already know and to confirm that a point has been understood instead of taking it for granted, a habit which I bring to teaching.

## 2. Approach

**Start from a question that matters to students.** In my teaching, I try to explain the purpose of any tool before describing how it is used. So, for example, when teaching price elasticity of demand, I would start by explaining the policy issue of subsidy reform for petroleum products and then show how price elasticity of demand can be used in the analysis of subsidy reform. Similarly, when teaching local projections I used my own research on climate shocks and UK food manufacturing to show how local projections can be applied to real-world policy questions. In these cases I make my code available to students so that they can see how the results in the lecture were obtained.

**Make assumptions visible.** When teaching econometrics, I try to make sure that students understand the underlying identification of the estimator that they are using, and how one can check whether the estimator is providing meaningful results. In my own research, careful robustness tests have more than once changed what a paper was able to claim, and I therefore stress to my students that placebo tests, pre-trend analysis and weak instrument tests on the regressions that they run are a way of testing an argument rather than a box-ticking exercise.

**Practise with real data.** When setting homework for students, I prefer to use publicly available data (for example, World Bank indicators, emissions inventories or household surveys) to set the exercises, so that students run into gaps, shifting definitions and awkward merges early on. I also try to ensure that the exercises are set in a reproducible format (using R or Python) so that others can understand how the results were obtained, and code that another person can rerun counts towards the mark.

**Inclusive classrooms.** I have studied and worked in a number of countries (Nigeria, Morocco and Brazil) and in a number of languages (English, French and Portuguese) and I am used to working with people from different countries and with different backgrounds, which has shown

me how much learning depends on students being comfortable asking simple questions. I plan to set a number of short, low-stakes in-class exercises for students so that I can understand how well students are understanding the material, and to give feedback that tells each student what to work on next.

### 3. Courses I can teach

At the undergraduate level, I would be interested in teaching: Principles of Microeconomics; Intermediate Microeconomics; Environmental and Natural Resource Economics; Introductory Econometrics; and Development Economics. At the Master's and Doctoral level I would be interested in teaching Environmental and Energy Economics; Climate Finance; Applied Econometrics for Policy Analysis (panel data econometrics, shift-share estimators, instrumental variable techniques, local projections, event studies); and Empirical Public Finance (taxation of energy and natural resources). I would be interested in supervising both undergraduate and master's dissertations related to the area of climate change, energy and development, and I can provide students with open datasets that I have built, which they can use for their research.

### 4. Development

In my first few years at the University, I will complete a recognised teaching qualification, such as Fellowship of Advance HE in the UK or its equivalent, and collect structured student feedback on all courses that I teach, so that I keep a record of how my teaching develops.